

Employee Handbook

Narsimha Tech | Effective: 1 January 2025 | Internal Use Only

1. Welcome to Narsimha Tech

1.1 Introduction

Welcome to Narsimha Tech! This handbook is your guide to our culture, expectations, and the resources available to help you thrive. Please read it carefully and refer to it whenever you have questions. This handbook complements, and should be read alongside, the Terms of Employment, the Detailed Leave Policy, and the Global Travel Policy.

1.2 About Narsimha Tech

Founded in 2015, Narsimha Tech is a technology solutions company specialising in cloud architecture, generative AI, and enterprise software engineering. We operate from offices in Hyderabad (HQ), Bengaluru, and Chennai, with remote delivery teams across 12 countries. Our clients span banking and financial services, healthcare, retail, and advanced manufacturing.

1.3 Mission and Values

Our Mission: "Empower organisations through secure, scalable, and human-centred technology." Our Core Values: Innovation First, Customer Success, Integrity Always, Collaborative Spirit, and Continuous Learning. These values inform how we hire, how we evaluate performance, and how we expect employees to engage with colleagues, clients, and partners.

1.4 Organisational Structure

Narsimha Tech is organised into client-facing Delivery Units (Banking & Financial Services, Healthcare, Retail, and Advanced Manufacturing), supported by horizontal Centers of Excellence (Cloud Architecture, Generative AI, Quality Engineering, and Data & Analytics) and corporate functions (HR, Finance, Legal, IT, and Corporate Communications). Org charts for each function are maintained on the intranet and updated quarterly.

1.5 How to Use This Handbook

This handbook is organised by topic and is intended as a practical reference. Where a topic is covered in more depth in a standalone policy (for example, leave or travel), this handbook provides a summary and points to the relevant standalone policy for full detail.

2. Code of Conduct

2.1 Overview

Every Narsimha Tech employee is expected to demonstrate the highest standards of professional behaviour. This means: treating all colleagues, clients, and vendors with respect and dignity regardless of their background; acting honestly and transparently in all business dealings; promptly disclosing any potential conflict of interest to your manager or HR; not accepting gifts exceeding INR 1,000 / USD 25 in value from any vendor, client, or business partner without prior written HR approval; using company resources (equipment, software, data, time) solely for legitimate business purposes; and representing Narsimha Tech positively on professional and social media platforms.

2.2 Gifts and Hospitality Register

Any gift or hospitality received that approaches or exceeds the INR 1,000 / USD 25 threshold must be logged in the Gifts & Hospitality Register, available on the intranet, regardless of whether it is ultimately accepted or declined. This creates transparency and protects both the employee and the Company in the event of a later audit or regulatory inquiry.

2.3 Anti-Bribery and Anti-Corruption

Employees must never offer, give, solicit, or accept a bribe or other improper advantage to influence a business decision, whether involving a government official, client representative, or any other third party. This applies regardless of local custom or practice, and regardless of whether the relevant jurisdiction's enforcement is strict or lax; Narsimha Tech applies a single global standard.

2.4 Anti-Money Laundering Awareness

Employees in finance, procurement, and client-billing roles must complete annual Anti-Money Laundering (AML) awareness training and must escalate any transaction or client request that appears unusual (for example, requests for payment via unconventional channels, or invoicing structures that do not match the underlying service) to the Finance Controller and Legal.

2.5 Conflicts of Interest

A conflict of interest arises whenever an employee's personal interests could improperly influence, or appear to influence, their professional judgement on behalf of the Company. Common examples include: a hiring manager interviewing a close relative; an employee holding a significant financial stake in a vendor or competitor; and an employee accepting outside work that competes for the same time and attention as their Narsimha Tech role. All actual or potential conflicts must be disclosed promptly via the Conflict of Interest disclosure form on the intranet.

2.6 Use of Company Resources

Company resources — including laptops, software licenses, cloud infrastructure credits, and paid subscriptions — must be used solely for legitimate business purposes. Incidental personal use (for example, checking personal email during a break) is generally tolerated provided it is reasonable, infrequent, and does not violate the IT & Information Security Policy.

2.7 Representing the Company

Employees representing Narsimha Tech positively on professional and social media platforms should avoid disclosing confidential information, avoid speaking on behalf of the Company on official matters unless authorised, and exercise good judgement in how they discuss their work, clients, and colleagues publicly.

2.8 Reporting Violations

Employees who observe or suspect a violation of the Code of Conduct should report it via their manager, HR, or — for matters they prefer to raise confidentially — via the channels described in Section 9 (Whistleblower Protection).

2.9 Consequences of Violations

Violations are addressed through the formal disciplinary process described in the Terms of Employment and may result in termination, and, in cases involving bribery, fraud, or other unlawful conduct, referral to law enforcement or regulatory authorities as appropriate.

3. Equal Opportunity, Anti-Harassment & POSH

3.1 Equal Opportunity Commitment

Narsimha Tech is an equal opportunity employer. We do not discriminate in hiring, promotion, or any term of employment on the basis of gender, gender identity, race, religion, caste, nationality, disability, age, marital status, or sexual orientation.

3.2 Harassment Prohibition

Harassment of any form — verbal, written, physical, visual, or digital — is strictly prohibited. This expressly includes sexual harassment as defined under the POSH Act (Prevention of Sexual Harassment at Workplace Act, 2013).

3.3 Forms of Harassment

Harassment may include, without limitation: unwelcome physical contact or advances; offensive jokes or comments about a protected characteristic; display or circulation of offensive images or material; persistent unwanted attention after being asked to stop; and digital harassment via email, chat, or social media in a work-related context.

3.4 Mandatory Training

All employees must complete the mandatory annual POSH awareness training, delivered via the Learning Management System, within 30 days of joining for new employees and by the annual deadline communicated by HR for existing employees.

3.5 Internal Complaints Committee

Complaints may be submitted confidentially to the Internal Complaints Committee (ICC) at icc@narsimhatech.com. The ICC is composed of a presiding officer (a senior woman employee), employee representatives, and an external member with expertise in women's issues, as required under the POSH Act.

3.6 Investigation Timeline

All complaints are investigated within 30 working days, in line with statutory requirements. The ICC will interview the complainant, the respondent, and relevant witnesses, review any documentary evidence, and submit a written report with findings and recommendations.

3.7 Interim Measures

During an investigation, the ICC may recommend interim measures such as temporary reassignment, leave for the complainant, or restricted contact between the parties, to ensure a safe working environment while the matter is being resolved.

3.8 Confidentiality

All aspects of a POSH complaint — the identity of the parties, the content of the complaint, and the proceedings — are kept strictly confidential, save for what is necessary to conduct a fair investigation and communicate the outcome to the parties.

3.9 Retaliation

Retaliation against a complainant or witness is a terminable offence. Any employee who believes they have experienced retaliation for raising a concern in good faith should report this immediately to HR or the ICC.

3.10 False Complaints

Where an investigation finds that a complaint was made maliciously and with knowledge that it was false, this may itself be treated as a Code of Conduct violation; however, a complaint that is investigated and not upheld is not, by itself, evidence of bad faith, and complainants acting in good faith are protected regardless of the outcome.

4. Information Technology & Security Policy

4.1 Acceptable Use

Company-issued devices must be used exclusively for business purposes and must run the approved endpoint detection and response (EDR) software at all times.

4.2 Prohibited Actions

Employees must not: install unauthorised software; use personal USB drives or external storage on company hardware without IT approval; leave workstations unlocked when unattended.

4.3 Password Standards

Passwords must be at least 12 characters, include uppercase, lowercase, digits, and symbols, and be changed every 90 days. Password reuse across the last 5 password cycles is not permitted.

4.4 Multi-Factor Authentication

Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) is mandatory for all company systems, including email, VPN, and any SaaS application processing Company or client data.

4.5 Incident Reporting

Suspected security incidents — phishing, data loss, unauthorised access — must be reported immediately to security@narsimhatech.com and to the CISO's office. Early reporting, even of a suspected near-miss (such as accidentally clicking a suspicious link), is encouraged and not penalised provided it is reported promptly.

4.6 Sensitive Data Handling

Sharing sensitive company data via personal email or unsanctioned cloud storage is prohibited and may constitute a data breach. Approved collaboration and storage tools are listed on the IT intranet page and should be the default choice for any work involving Confidential or Restricted data (see Terms of Employment, Section 8.3).

4.7 Bring Your Own Device (BYOD)

Where a role permits limited use of personal devices for business purposes (for example, checking email on a personal phone), the device must be enrolled in the Company's Mobile Device Management (MDM) system, which enforces a minimum security baseline and allows for remote wipe of Company data in the event of loss or offboarding.

4.8 Software and Asset Management

All software installed on Company devices must be approved through the IT Software Catalogue; requests for new software should be raised via the IT Service Desk and will be reviewed for security, licensing, and cost considerations before approval.

5. Remote Work Policy

5.1 Eligibility

Employees whose roles are designated as hybrid-eligible may work remotely up to 3 days per week, subject to written manager approval.

5.2 Nature of the Privilege

Remote work is a privilege, not a right, and may be withdrawn based on performance, role requirements, or business needs.

5.3 Expectations While Remote

Remote employees must maintain the same availability, professionalism, and output quality as when on-site, including adherence to core hours described in the Terms of Employment.

5.4 Connectivity and Security Requirements

A stable, secure, private internet connection is required; use of public Wi-Fi is prohibited unless a company-issued VPN is active.

5.5 New Joiner On-Site Requirement

New employees are required to complete their first 3 months fully on-site before becoming eligible for hybrid work arrangements, to support onboarding, relationship-building, and supervised skill development.

5.6 Data Handling While Remote

All company data handling policies apply equally in remote environments; working from a shared or public space (such as a café) is discouraged for any work involving Confidential or Restricted information.

5.7 Home Office Ergonomics

Employees working remotely are encouraged to set up an ergonomically appropriate workspace; the Company's Learning Management System includes a short module on home office ergonomics, and IT can advise on requesting a basic ergonomic accessory (such as a monitor stand or external keyboard) through the standard asset request process where budget allows.

5.8 Fully Remote Roles

Certain roles, particularly in international remote delivery, may be designated fully remote rather than hybrid, in which case the 3-day cap in Section 5.1 does not apply, but all other expectations in this section continue

to apply in full.

6. Employee Benefits

6.1 Health Insurance

Group Mediclaim Health Insurance covers the employee, spouse, and up to 2 dependent children (sum insured: INR 5 lakhs per family per annum, with a top-up option to INR 10 lakhs at subsidised premiums). Enrolment and dependent additions are managed through the HR Self-Service Portal during the annual benefits window or within 30 days of a qualifying life event (marriage, birth of a child).

6.2 Life Insurance

Group Term Life Insurance is provided at 5x the employee's annual CTC, with the nominee designated by the employee through the HR Self-Service Portal; employees are strongly encouraged to keep their nominee details current, particularly after a change in marital or family status.

6.3 Provident Fund

Employee Provident Fund (EPF) — employer contribution of 12% of basic salary — is mandatory and managed in accordance with statutory requirements, with employee contributions matched at the statutory rate described in the Terms of Employment.

6.4 Gratuity

Gratuity is payable as per the Payment of Gratuity Act, 1972 (applicable after 5 years of service), calculated on the formula prescribed under that Act based on the employee's last drawn basic salary and completed years of service.

6.5 Performance Bonus

Performance Bonus of up to 20% of annual CTC is available as described in the Terms of Employment, Section 6.5.

6.6 Internet Reimbursement

Internet Reimbursement for hybrid/remote employees is available up to INR 1,500 per month, claimed via the standard expense process upon submission of the relevant internet service provider invoice.

6.7 Meal Vouchers

Meal Vouchers (Sodexo / Zeta) are provided at INR 2,200 per month, credited to the employee's voucher account on a monthly basis alongside payroll.

6.8 Birthday Leave

Birthday Leave provides 1 additional day of leave on or adjacent to the employee's birthday, as detailed further in the Detailed Leave Policy, Section 10.1.

6.9 Employee Assistance Programme (EAP)

Narsimha Tech provides a confidential Employee Assistance Programme offering counselling support for personal, family, and work-related stress, accessible via a dedicated helpline and online portal detailed on the intranet Wellbeing page. Use of the EAP is confidential and is not visible to the employee's manager or recorded in the employee's personnel file.

6.10 Wellness Benefits

Employees have access to a subsidised gym membership programme through partner fitness providers, an annual health check-up (for employees above a service threshold communicated by HR), and periodic wellness webinars covering topics such as nutrition, sleep, and stress management.

6.11 Childcare Support

Employees with children under school age may apply for a partial subsidy toward registered daycare costs, subject to a cap and documentation requirements communicated annually by HR, as part of the Company's broader family-friendly benefits suite.

6.12 Benefits Summary Table

Benefit	Provision
Health Insurance	INR 5 lakhs (top-up to INR 10 lakhs), employee + spouse + 2 children
Life Insurance	5x annual CTC
EPF (Employer)	12% of basic salary
Gratuity	Per Payment of Gratuity Act, 1972, after 5 years' service
Performance Bonus	Up to 20% of annual CTC
Internet Reimbursement	Up to INR 1,500/month (hybrid/remote)
Meal Vouchers	INR 2,200/month
Birthday Leave	1 day

7. Learning & Development

7.1 Annual L&D; Budget

Each employee receives an annual Learning & Development budget of INR 50,000 (approx. USD 600) for external courses, certifications, books, and conference attendance, accessible via a simple reimbursement claim with manager sign-off confirming relevance to the employee's role or development plan.

7.2 Learning Management System

The internal Learning Management System (LMS) provides access to a curated library of thousands of online courses spanning technical, leadership, and compliance topics, available at no additional cost beyond standard Company access.

7.3 Sponsored Certifications

Company-sponsored technical certifications include: AWS (Solutions Architect, DevOps), Microsoft Azure (AZ-900 to AZ-305), Google Cloud, PMP, and Certified Scrum Master. Employees can nominate themselves for a sponsored certification via the LMS, subject to manager approval and the relevance of the certification to current or planned role requirements.

7.4 Certification Recognition Bonus

Employees who pass a sponsored certification receive a one-time recognition bonus of INR 10,000, paid in the payroll cycle following submission of the certification confirmation to HR.

7.5 Training Bonds

Where the Company funds a high-cost certification or training programme (typically above a threshold communicated at the time of sponsorship), the employee may be asked to sign a training bond committing to a minimum service period (typically 12 months) following completion; if the employee resigns within that period, a pro-rated portion of the training cost is recoverable from the final settlement, as referenced in the Terms of Employment, Section 6.8.

7.6 Internal Mobility

Internal job openings are published on the intranet for at least 2 weeks before external advertising to prioritise internal mobility, giving existing employees the first opportunity to apply for new roles across the organisation.

7.7 Mentorship Programme

Narsimha Tech operates a voluntary mentorship programme connecting employees with more senior colleagues outside their direct reporting line, for career guidance and skill development; employees can register their interest as a mentor or mentee via the LMS.

7.8 Conference and External Learning Attendance

Requests to attend external conferences or industry events, where costs exceed the standard L&D; budget, may be considered for additional department-level sponsorship, subject to department head approval and a brief post-event knowledge-sharing session with the team.

8. Performance & Talent Processes Overview

8.1 Cross-Reference to Terms of Employment

The core performance review cycle, rating scale, and Performance Improvement Plan process are described in full in the Terms of Employment, Sections 4 (Probation) and 7 (Performance Management). This handbook provides a high-level overview and signposts employees to the relevant detailed sections.

8.2 Talent Reviews

In addition to individual performance reviews, the Company conducts an annual Talent Review process at department level, identifying high-potential employees for accelerated development and succession planning for key roles. Participation in a Talent Review does not entitle an employee to a specific promotion or assignment but is factored into development planning discussions with their manager.

8.3 Promotions

Promotions are considered as part of the April salary review cycle (see Terms of Employment, Section 6.4) and, in exceptional cases of significant scope change, on an off-cycle basis with HR Director approval. Promotion criteria combine sustained performance ratings, demonstrated competency at the next grade, and business need for the role.

8.4 Career Pathways

Narsimha Tech maintains documented career pathways for technical (individual contributor) and managerial tracks, available on the intranet, outlining the typical competencies and experience expected at each grade to support employees in planning their development.

9. Grievance Redressal & Whistleblower Protection

9.1 Four-Step Grievance Process

Narsimha Tech has a four-step grievance process:

- Step 1: Raise the concern informally with the immediate manager within 10 working days of the event.
- Step 2: If unresolved within 5 working days, submit a formal written grievance to HR via grievance@narsimhatech.com.
- Step 3: HR acknowledges within 2 working days and aims to resolve the matter within 15 working days through investigation and mediation.
- Step 4: If the outcome is unsatisfactory, the employee may escalate to the HR Director within 5 working days; the Director's decision is final within the internal process.

9.2 Confidentiality

All grievances are handled with strict confidentiality and without prejudice to the employee's standing or career progression.

9.3 Matters Outside the Standard Grievance Process

POSH-related complaints follow the dedicated ICC process described in Section 3, not the general grievance process. Suspected fraud, bribery, or serious legal/regulatory violations should be raised through the Whistleblower channel described in Section 9.4, given the heightened confidentiality and independent-investigation requirements for such matters.

9.4 Whistleblower Protection

Employees who become aware of suspected fraud, corruption, serious safety violations, or other serious wrongdoing may report this confidentially via the Whistleblower Hotline (details on the intranet Ethics page) or directly to the Head of Internal Audit. Reports may be made anonymously where the reporting channel supports this. The Company strictly prohibits retaliation against anyone raising a genuine, good-faith concern through this channel, regardless of whether the concern is ultimately substantiated.

9.5 Whistleblower Investigation Process

Whistleblower reports are triaged by Internal Audit or Legal (depending on the nature of the concern) and investigated independently of the reporting employee's management chain, with findings reported to the Audit Committee where the matter is sufficiently material.

9.6 Choosing the Right Channel

Type of Concern	Recommended Channel
Day-to-day management or interpersonal issue	Line manager, then Grievance process (Section 9.1)
Sexual harassment	Internal Complaints Committee (Section 3.5)
Suspected fraud, bribery, or serious legal violation	Whistleblower Hotline (Section 9.4)
Security incident or data breach	security@narsimhatech.com (Section 4.5)
Disagreement with a performance rating	Manager, then HR Business Partner (Terms of Employment, Section 7.8)

10. Workplace Health & Safety

10.1 General Commitment

Narsimha Tech is committed to providing a safe and healthy working environment across all office locations, consistent with applicable occupational health and safety law.

10.2 Office Safety Standards

All office locations maintain fire safety equipment, clearly marked emergency exits, and periodic fire drills, coordinated by the Facilities team at each location. Employees should familiarise themselves with the emergency evacuation plan displayed at their floor's notice board.

10.3 Incident Reporting

Any workplace accident, injury, or near-miss must be reported to Facilities and HR within 24 hours using the Workplace Incident Report form available on the intranet, regardless of how minor the incident may seem.

10.4 Ergonomic Assessments

Employees experiencing discomfort related to their workstation setup may request an ergonomic assessment through Facilities, which can include adjustments to chair, desk height, or monitor positioning, or referral to occupational health support for persistent issues.

10.5 Workplace Violence

Narsimha Tech has zero tolerance for workplace violence, threats, or intimidating behaviour of any kind. Any such incident should be reported immediately to Facilities security and HR, and may result in immediate suspension pending investigation, consistent with the gross misconduct provisions in the Terms of Employment.

10.6 Substance-Free Workplace

Employees must not be under the influence of alcohol or illegal drugs while performing Company duties, whether on Company premises or client sites; a genuine breach of this standard is treated as a serious conduct matter, addressed through the disciplinary process with appropriate support (including EAP referral where relevant) considered alongside any disciplinary outcome.

11. Diversity, Equity & Inclusion

11.1 Commitment

Building on the Equal Opportunity commitment in Section 3, Narsimha Tech actively works to build a diverse and inclusive workplace where employees from all backgrounds can succeed.

11.2 Employee Resource Groups

The Company supports voluntary Employee Resource Groups (ERGs), including groups focused on women in technology, LGBTQ+ inclusion, and persons with disabilities, which organise events, mentorship, and advocacy activities. Details of active ERGs and how to join are available on the intranet.

11.3 Accessibility

Employees requiring workplace accommodations related to a disability or medical condition should contact HR to discuss reasonable accommodations, which may include adjusted equipment, flexible scheduling, or accessible workspace modifications.

11.4 Inclusive Hiring

Hiring panels are encouraged to include diverse interviewer representation where feasible, and job descriptions are reviewed periodically to remove unnecessarily exclusionary language or requirements.

11.5 Pay Equity

The Company periodically conducts internal pay equity reviews to identify and address any unexplained pay disparities across gender or other protected characteristics within comparable roles and grades.

12. Recruitment, Onboarding & Probation Overview

12.1 Recruitment Principles

All hiring decisions are based on merit, skills, and fit for the role, consistent with the Equal Opportunity commitment in Section 3. Hiring managers must complete the Company's standard interview process, including any required structured assessments, before extending an offer.

12.2 Employee Referral Programme

Employees may refer candidates for open roles via the intranet referral portal and are eligible for a referral bonus, paid after the referred candidate completes a defined minimum service period (typically 3 months), with bonus amounts varying by role seniority as published on the intranet.

12.3 Background Verification

All offers of employment are subject to satisfactory background verification, covering identity, education, and prior employment, conducted by an approved third-party verification agency. Any material discrepancy identified may result in withdrawal of the offer or, if already joined, termination of employment.

12.4 Onboarding Journey

New joiners follow a structured 90-day onboarding journey, including: Day 1 orientation covering Company policies, IT setup, and benefits enrolment; a 30-day check-in with HR and the line manager; and a 90-day review aligned with the end of the initial onboarding period, distinct from the 6-month probation review cadence described in the Terms of Employment.

12.5 Buddy Programme

Each new joiner is assigned a peer "buddy" (typically a colleague in a similar role, not their direct manager) for their first 90 days, to help them navigate day-to-day questions and build early connections within the team.

13. Travel & Expenses Overview

13.1 Cross-Reference

All business travel is governed by the standalone Global Travel Policy, which covers authorisation thresholds, booking guidelines, per diems, ground transportation, expense reporting, travel insurance, and duty-of-care obligations in full detail.

13.2 Quick Reference

Employees should consult the Global Travel Policy before booking any business trip; key actions include obtaining advance approval via the Travel Portal, booking through the authorised TMC, and submitting expenses via SAP Concur within 10 business days of return.

14. Communication, Tools & Office Logistics

14.1 Approved Collaboration Tools

Narsimha Tech's standard collaboration suite includes corporate email, an enterprise chat and video conferencing platform, and a project tracking tool, all provisioned automatically upon joining. Use of unapproved external tools for business communication or file sharing is discouraged and, for Confidential or Restricted data, prohibited under the IT & Information Security Policy.

14.2 Internal Communications Channels

Company-wide updates are communicated via a monthly all-hands meeting, a fortnightly newsletter, and the intranet homepage. Employees are encouraged to raise questions during all-hands Q&A; segments or via the anonymous question submission tool used during these sessions.

14.3 Office Access and Security Badges

Employees are issued a security badge for office access on their first day. Lost or stolen badges must be reported immediately to Facilities so the badge can be deactivated; a replacement fee may apply for repeated loss.

14.4 Visitor Policy

All visitors, including client guests and candidate interviewees, must be registered in advance via the visitor management system and escorted within the office premises by the hosting employee at all times.

14.5 Workstation and Seating

Seating allocation is managed by Facilities in coordination with team leads; employees relocating between floors or offices should raise a request via the Facilities ticketing system at least 5 working days in advance where possible.

15. Handbook Governance

15.1 Acknowledgement

All employees are required to acknowledge that they have read and understood this Employee Handbook as part of their onboarding process, and again upon any material update communicated by HR.

15.2 Relationship to Other Policies

Where this handbook and a standalone policy (Terms of Employment, Detailed Leave Policy, Global Travel Policy, or any other Company policy) address the same topic in differing levels of detail, the standalone policy is the authoritative source; this handbook is intended as a navigable summary and orientation guide.

15.3 Updates

Narsimha Tech reserves the right to update this handbook periodically to reflect evolving practices, legal requirements, and employee feedback. Material updates are communicated via the channels described in Section 14.2.

15.4 Document Control

Attribute	Detail
Document Owner	Head of Human Resources
Review Frequency	Annual
Last Reviewed	January 2025
Related Documents	Terms of Employment; Detailed Leave Policy; Global Travel Policy; Code of Conduct & Business Ethics Policy; IT & Information Security Policy